ST. PAUL'S UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST • OPEN AND AFFIRMING

Worship Service

Easter Sunday

Sunday, April 5, 2026 | 10:30 AM

WE GATHER

- **Welcome and Announcements** — Rev. Dr. Dietmar Plajer

🎵 **Prelude** — *"He Arose"* — Jaime Namminga

- **Call to Worship**
  Leader: Christ is risen!
  All: Christ is risen indeed!
  Leader: Let us celebrate the living God who conquers death.
  All: Christ is risen indeed! Alleluia!

🎼 **Hymn of Praise** — **#232** *"Jesus Christ Is Risen Today"* — (verses 1, 2, 4) - piano and trumpet

- **Prayer of Invocation** — Collectively
  God of new creation, thank you for raising us with Jesus to a new life. We are in awe of your power to renew and transform us. Your hope, love, and joy flood our souls. Your music lifts our spirits. Yet the powers of darkness still grab hold of us. We often feel limited and stuck. Help us emerge from our confining cocoons, unfurl our wings, and take flight. Transform us through the power of your love. Mold us and shape us into the image of Christ. In his holy name we pray. Amen

🎼 **Gloria** — **#243** *"Be Not Afraid"* — (sing twice)

WE SHARE THE WORD

🎵 **Offering of Music** — Joyful Noise Choir

🎼 **Hymn** — **#188** *"Jesus Loves Me"*

- **Children's Message** — Linda Gruenberg
  The piano plays softly "Jesus Loves Me" until the children return to their families or go to the nursery. There is no Sunday school today.

- **Scripture Readings** — Morgan Lewis
  Prayer for Illumination
  Hebrew Scripture: Jeremiah 31:1–6
  Gospel: Matthew 28:1–10

🎼 **Scripture Reading Response** — *"This is God's Word for the people of God"*

- **Message/Sermon** — *"My Religion is Love"* — Pastor Dietmar

🎵 **Offering of Music** — *"The Messiah Has Come"* — by Pepper Choplin - Senior Choir

WE RESPOND WITH THANKSGIVING

🎵 **Offering Announcement** — Pastor Dietmar

🎵 **Offering of Music** — *"Jesus Paid It All"* — Jaime Namminga

- **Doxology** — **#607** *"Praise God from Whom All Blessings Flow"*

HOLY COMMUNION

- **Invitation**

🎼 **Communion Song** — **#497** *"Bread of Life From Heaven"* — (refrain, verse 3, refrain)

- **Consecration and Prayer**
- **Words of Institution**
- **Sharing of the Bread and Cup (soft music is welcome as we commune)**
  Communion Servers: Jean LeGros, Joanne Lauer, Cheryl Reddinger, Gary Leitzel, Jack Lewis, Jon Stante

PRAYER

- **Prayers of the People**
- **The Lord's Prayer**

WE ARE SENT

🎼 **Hymn of Mission** — **#250** *"Hymn of Promise"* — (all 3 verses) - piano and trumpet

- **Blessing** — Pastor Dietmar

🎼 **Benediction Response** — **#43** *"On Eagle's Wings"* — (refrain only)
We invite you to hold hands during this song. Hand sanitizer is available in the foyer.

🎵 **Postlude** — *"Jesus Saves!"* — Jaime Namminga

Acolyte: Dakota Namminga
Greeters: Cheryl Reddinger & Shirley Varner